

Activity: Build Your Own Threat Matrix

Threat Actor	Motivation	Method/Vector	Explanation
Script Kiddie	Disruption for fun or recognition	Website defacement	Inexperienced individuals looking to impress peers or cause mischief
Insider	Revenge/Financial Gain	USB drop with Malware	Employees, or other with access who might be disgruntled, and want vengeance and/or financial gain
Cybercriminal	Financial Gain	Phishing email	Individual or group trying to access login credentials for financial gain

The Script Kiddie is usually someone who lacks technical experience, and their goal is usually just to impress peers, or cause trouble for their entertainment. They present a low risk level.

The insider is usually an employee, but could also be a contractor or partner with access. These can present as intentional, or unintentional. Unintentional is usually a lapse in judgement or mistake, such as clicking a phishing email, or falling for a social engineering ploy. Intentional is more like a disgruntled employee who might want revenge for perceived wrong, or is trying to have some financial gain due to their insider access. These are a high risk level, because they can bypass defenses.

The cybercriminal is a profit-driven attacker. Can be an individual, but is often part of a group. Their goal, and motivation is financial, they may want to steal data, or extort money (ransomware). They institute a high risk level due to their persistence, and skill level.